M-Pesa

2007 | NAIROBI, KENYA

REVENUE / SCALE (2025)
~$1B+ (Est.)

ACTIVE USERS
50M+ Active Users

OVERVIEW

M-Pesa is a pioneering mobile phone-based money transfer, financing, and microfinancing service that operates over standard SMS/USSD networks.

MISSION & PURPOSE

To transform lives by providing accessible, affordable, and secure mobile financial services to the unbanked.

NOTABLE IMPACT

"M-Pesa hailed as the global grandfather of mobile money. M-Pesa lifted an estimated 2% of Kenyan households out of extreme poverty simply by providing a secure way to save and transfer money."

FOUNDER PROFILE

Launched as a joint venture by Safaricom (led then by CEO Michael Joseph) and Vodafone (spearheaded by Nick Hughes), originally funded in part by the UK's DFID.